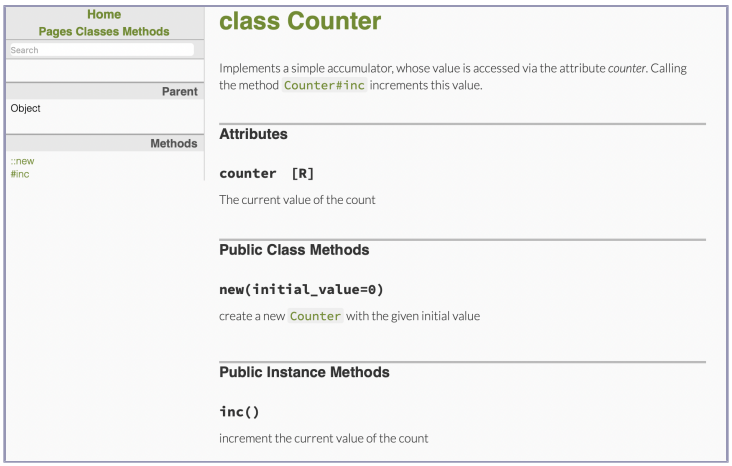


Notice how the comments before each element now appear in the RDoc output, reformatted into HTML. Less obvious is that RDoc has detected hyperlink opportunities in our comments: In the class-level comment, the reference to `Counter#inc` is a hyperlink to the method description, and in the comment for the `new` method, the reference to class `Counter` hyperlinks back to the class documentation. This is a key feature of RDoc: It is designed to be unintrusive in the Ruby source files and to make up for this by trying to be clever when producing output.

RDoc can also be used to produce documentation that can be read by the ri command-line utility. For example, if we ask RDoc to document the code in the previous example into ri format (with `$ rdoc -r .`), we can access the documentation from the command line:

```
$ ri Counter
 = Counter < Object

(from /Users/noel/.local/share/rdoc)
------------------------------------------------------------------------
Implements a simple accumulator, whose value is accessed via the
attribute counter. Calling the method Counter#inc
increments this value.
------------------------------------------------------------------------
= Class methods:

  new

= Instance methods:

  counter, inc

= Attributes:

  attr_reader counter
```

The documentation will even get picked up by irb: